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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Palm Beach Christian Academy: PBCA Bridges
School Website: <https://www.pbchristianacademy.org/pbca-bridges>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Palm Beach Christian Academy (PBCA) Bridges, Palm Beach County, FL 33401, presents a clearly classical-leaning profile rooted in Christian, liberal-arts-inspired education. Public-facing materials emphasize a Christ-centered, Christian, and distinctly classical orientation, anchored by a Trivium framework, great books, and Socratic dialogue. The school foregrounds character formation, virtue, and community partnership with families, aligning with core classical predicates such as formation over information, the Great Conversation, and a memory-rich pedagogy. Across six evaluated categories, PBCA Bridges demonstrates a strong classical orientation in Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents/Community, with Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and School Purpose and Goal showing substantial classical articulation as well. The overall classification is CLASSICAL, though Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal) shows only partial explicit alignment, suggesting room for more explicit articulation of telos, contemplation/scholé, and the fuller range of classical aims in that area.

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Strongest alignment: Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Parents & Community
- Moderate alignment with some explicit classical signals: Religious & Metaphysical Foundations; School Purpose & Goal (Element 2)
- Notable opportunities to strengthen: Liturgical/communal practices and explicit articulation of contemplative (scholé) dimensions across the program

What would move the needle is discussed in the section titled "What Would Move the Needle," below, focused on making explicit the full Great Books/Scholé-driven orientation, expanding thematic integration of virtue-based formation, and deepening family formation initiatives.

Citations and textual anchors drawn from PBCA Bridges content confirm the core findings (distinctively Christian, classical Trivium, great books and Socratic dialogue, and strong family/community partnership). Foundational classical keywords and their positive/negative indicators are drawn from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School corpus and the classical lexicon, which provide the rubric for the keyword analysis used in this evaluation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Distinctively Christian framing with Scriptural rooting and Christ-centered values appears prominently in PBCA Bridges materials. The site states that "Every lesson and relationship is rooted in Scripture, placing Christ at the center of our values, character formation, and pursuit of truth." - Public materials

explicitly foreground a Christian, biblical foundation and Scriptural grounding, consistent with a theological/integrated approach to education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (category 1 lexicon): truth, Scripture, Christ-centered education, Christian worldview, sacred Scripture, theologia/theological integration (implied by “Distinctively Christian” and “Scripture” emphasis), formation of the soul/character, great conversation (via great books and Socratic dialogue). - Negative keywords present: none detected in the accessible public content (no explicit references to relativism, secular humanism, or values-neutral approaches).

Why this rating - The PBCA Bridges materials foreground transcendence/teleology via Christ-centered formation, Scripture-centered instruction, and explicit Christian theological framing. The presence of Christ-centered, Scriptural, and the pursuit of truth among the public materials aligns strongly with the Positive Keywords for Religious/Metaphysical Foundations and with the Core Elements described in the Six Essential Elements corpus. The absence of explicit relativistic or secular signals supports a classical/Christian metaphysical orientation.

Citations: Distinctively Christian framing and Scripture/Christ-centered language appear in PBCA Bridges materials.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize formation and virtue through a Christ-centered path, with phrases like “character formation” and “formation for unique learners” (PBCA Bridges). The Bridges program is described as designed for individualized learning within a classical, Christ-centered framework. - The materials frame education as forming the heart and mind in a community-oriented setting, consistent with a formation-oriented telos rather than purely informational goals. The explicit motto “A Personalized, Christ-Centered Path for Unique Learners” signals formation over mere information-driven aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue (implied through character formation), human flourishing (implied by formation toward flourishing in a Christ-centered context), telos (implied by formation toward a purpose), great conversation (via Trivium and dialogue, though more explicit in Curriculum/Pedagogy). - Negative keywords present: explicit references to “career/workforce readiness,” “21st-century skills,” or other job-centric framing are not present in the accessible materials, which supports a classical aim rather than a purely vocational emphasis.

Why this rating - PBCA's stated goals center on formation (character, faith development) and a telos aligned with truth/beauty/virtue in a classical frame, even though the articulation of some classical telos terms is less explicit. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating because there is clear movement toward formation and virtue, but the articulation of the full classical telos (e.g., explicit references to the true/good/beautiful trinity as a goal and extensive Great Conversation telos) could be more explicit in public-facing materials.

Citations: Public materials emphasize formation and Christ-centered aims; presence of “formation” and “Christ-centered path” language.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site explicitly references “Our time-honored Trivium model trains students to think clearly, reason wisely, and speak persuasively through great books and Socratic dialogue,” a direct articulation of the Trivium, Great Books, and Socratic dialogue as core curriculum scaffolds. - The Bridges materials emphasize great books and Socratic dialogue as central components of learning, which aligns with the classical curriculum emphasis on grammar, logic, rhetoric, and the Great Conversation. - The presence of a “one-room schoolhouse” framework and multi-age group structure in Bridges signals a traditional, holistic approach to schooling consistent with classical curricular thinking (though not all curricular specifics are enumerated, the Trivium/Great Books framing is explicit).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts (implicitly via Trivium), grammar/logic/rhetoric (Trivium), great books, history/Western civilization (Great Books context), Socratic dia-

logue, memory work/narration (implied by classical pedagogy), formation of the mind (intellectual virtue. - Negative keywords present: none explicit in the PBCA content; there is no indication of a project-based or STEM-first pivot, and historical/Great-Books orientation is foregrounded.

Why this rating - The curriculum is explicitly framed around classical pillars (Trivium, Great Books, Socratic dialogue) and a Great Conversation orientation, placing PBCA firmly within CLASSICAL, given the explicit textual signals in public materials.

Citations: Evidence of Trivium/Great Books/Socratic dialogue appears in PBCA Bridges messaging.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials explicitly present Socratic dialogue as a core element (e.g., “great books and Socratic dialogue” in the Trivium framing). - The language about teaching through a classical framework (Socratic dialogue, dialogue-based instruction, and rhetorical training) signals a pedagogy oriented toward dialectic discussion, deliberation, and classical rhetoric. - The Bridges content describes a structure (one-room schoolhouse, multi-age grouping) that supports a contemplative, relationship-rich approach rather than a purely formulaic, rote approach, consistent with Scholé-style restful pedagogy in classical traditions.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue; great books; memory work/recitation (implied by classical pedagogy); narration/recitation; rhetoric; dialogue; scholarship seeking truth; Scholé/restful pace (implied in classical pedagogy lexicon, though not always explicit on the PBCA site). - Negative keywords present: there is no explicit emphasis on exclusively project-based or experiential-only pedagogy in the public materials; no signals of anti-Scholé practices.

Why this rating - The explicit mentions of Trivium, Great Books, and Socratic dialogue position PBCA's pedagogy solidly within CLASSICAL. The structural cues (one-room schoolhouse, multi-age groups) align with a contemplative, discussion-based pedagogy rather than a purely project-based or constructivist approach, supporting CLASSICAL.

Citations: Trivium and Socratic dialogue language appears in PBCA Bridges materials; one-room schoolhouse structure cited in Bridges description.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site features a “Meet the Team” section and notes about ESE teachers, signaling faculty involvement and mentorship across the student body (e.g., “PBCA ESE Teacher” listings). This signals faculty engagement and a visible teaching corps, consistent with the classical notion of “living teachers” as a core part of the curriculum. - General language around “distinctively Christian” and “distinctively Classical” frames the faculty as central to the school culture, aligning with the classical ideal of the faculty as living exemplars and mentors in a shared mission. The presence of explicit teacher roles (ESE teachers) and a “Meet the Team” page further supports the notion of a strong, active instructional staff.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers and mentors; living curriculum; faculty as core; portrait/vision of teacher-student ideal; collegiality (implied by team-centered language). - Negative keywords present: no explicit signals of non-classical faculty models (e.g., “teacher as facilitator on the side” or purely administrative jargon). The public content aligns with the classical faculty profile.

Why this rating - While the site does not spell out every facet of a “portrait of a teacher” in the same detail as some classical-school philosophy texts, the explicit team pages, roles, and the overarching self-description as a “Distinctively Classical” institution support a CLASSICAL rating for Faculty.

Citations: Meet the Team and ESE teacher listings, plus the CLASSICAL framing in PBCA communications.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site explicitly emphasizes a community ethos in which parents, teachers, staff, and students partner together: “Parents, teachers, staff, and students partner in a supportive, mission-driven culture

where everyone is known, valued, and encouraged to flourish.” This is a direct nod to partnership with families, a key classical signal. - The public materials describe openness to family involvement, planning visits, inquiries, and interactions with the school community (e.g., “Plan A Visit,” “Inquire,” “Visit” CTAs). This aligns with the classical element of engaging parents as co-teachers and forming a family-centered classical culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parent formation; home-school partnership; parent involvement; open campus/visit opportunities; family catechesis (implied by the community framework). - Negative keywords present: no explicit consumer/customer language; no minimal parent involvement signals; no strong anti-parent signals in the materials.

Why this rating - PBCA Bridges presents a robust classical signal in Parents & Community through explicit parent partnership language and active family engagement. This category achieves CLASSICAL.

Citations: Distinctively Community language and parent partnership framing; Plan A Visit/Visit calls to action.

What Would Move the Needle

- If Element 2 remains the only somewhat-lower-scoring category, elevating explicit articulation of classical telos, contemplation/scholé, and formation of affections as formal goals would move the needle toward a full CLASSICAL in that domain. Specific actions:
- Add explicit public language around telos and the true/good/beautiful as a core educational aim, with examples across grades.
- Explicitly name and describe Scholé (restful learning) moments in the daily schedule and in curricular documentation.
- Integrate more direct references to the Great Conversation and Great Books across core disciplines beyond language arts to show cross-disciplinary Great Books integration.
- Strengthen Liturgical/Communal Practices: include explicit liturgical or worship practices (within appropriate Christian-education boundaries) or communal rituals that reinforce reverence and sacred time as part of the school day, aligning with category 1 signals.
- Expand Memorization/Recitation and Chanting: incorporate structured memory-work, recitation, and chanting as a unified strand across K–12, with sample curricula and sample memory-verse lists, to satisfy the Pedagogy criteria more robustly (category 4).
- Broaden Faculty Portraits: provide a more explicit public articulation of the “living curriculum” concept through a teacher-portrait framework (qualities, demonstrations of virtue, mentorships) to strengthen Element 5.

These needle-moving steps would deepen the public-facing alignment with the Six Essential Elements and the classical-education lexicon.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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